

# David Gao. 3476817435 • [david.04.gao@gmail.com](mailto:david.04.gao@gmail.com) • [linkedin.com/in/david0w0](https://www.linkedin.com/in/david0w0)

Detail-oriented computer science student passionate about systems design and scalable architecture.

Available May 2026

## EDUCATION

### Rochester Institute of Technology, Rochester, NY

Expected May 2026

- BS in Game Design and Development, BS in English; Media and Literature, Film Studies Minor
- Dean's List: Fall 2022 - Spring 2025

GPA: 3.85

### Relevant Coursework:

Game Development and Algorithmic Programming I & II (C#, OOP), Experience Design Games & Media (UX Design and Implementation, Axure RP), Game Design and Development II (Agile/Scrum Methodology), Rich Media Web Development I (Webpack, Firebase, Bulma, React, TypeScript, Node.js), Data Structures and Algorithms for Games & Simulations I & II, Intro to Database and Database Modeling (SQL, normalization, data modeling, relational models)

## SKILLS

Languages: C#, C++, JavaScript, Java, TypeScript, HTML, CSS, SQL, ReactJS, lua, Python

Software: Photoshop, Premiere Pro, GitHub, Git, Unreal Engine, Unity, Procreate, InDesign, Maya, Blender

## PROJECTS

### Last Day on the Frontier

Aug 2025 - Present

Unity, C#

- Developed a minimum viable product of an expansive choices matter narrative western video game with different endings and small choices which continually change the narrative
- Designed a finite state machine that keeps track of player's current state throughout several game states
- Built a centralized dialogue manager with the capability to change speaker, dialogue, play animations, and nested branching paths for scalable narrative design and reusable dialogue logic

### Prison

September 2025

Javascript, HTML, CSS

- Designed an anti-idle game about the burden of consciousness through the physical representation of unconscious and conscious thoughts. Players must actively click in order to counter the automatic generation of unconscious thoughts, or otherwise purchase events and upgrades, represented by real life actions, in order to limit the deterioration of one's consciousness
- Implemented save persistence and offline progress as part of its thematic commentary on an individual's compulsory existence
- Created with intention to be "hostile" to the player, requiring constant play in order to progress or risk losing

### Bathysphere

June 2025 - August 2025

LÖVE2D, lua

- Developed an idle working simulator taking place in a speculative environment
- Implemented time-based simulation logic to handle idle progression and resource accumulation
- Designed data structures to track player progression, upgrades, and environmental state throughout gameplay

## WORK EXPERIENCE

### Waiter

Jun 2025 - Aug 2025

Shogun Legacy, Tom's River, NY

- Served guests efficiently in a fast-paced restaurant environment, handling an entire room of 30+ guests simultaneously
- Assisted other waiters, bussers, and runners during high-volume periods to ensure guest satisfaction

### STEM Instructor

Jul 2024 - Aug 2024

Lavner Education, Manhattan, NY

- Educated students on game design principles in Gamemaker while tailoring lessons to diverse learning styles
- Communicated with the team to ensure the workday ran smoothly and students would be supported throughout their learning process